INCH-POUND
MIL-PRF-64266/13
9 September 2010

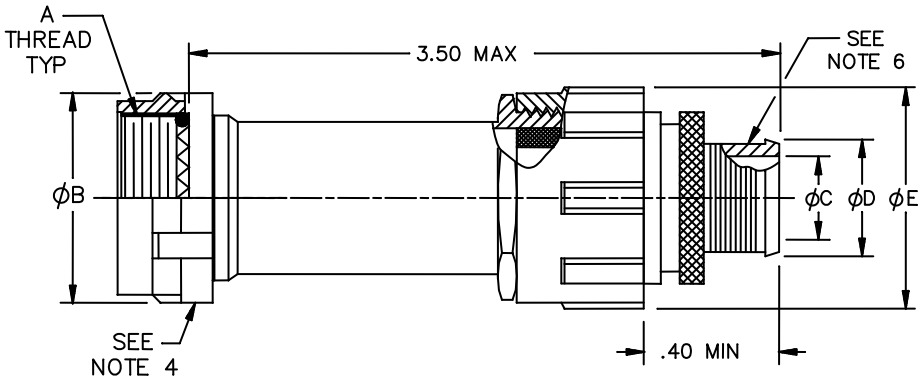
PERFORMANCE SPECIFICATION SHEET

CONNECTORS, FIBER OPTIC, CIRCULAR, PLUG AND RECEPTACLE STYLE, MULTIPLE REMOVABLE GENDERLESS TERMINI, SCREW THREADS, BACKSHELL, SOLID, SINGLE FIBER CABLES, BANDED ADAPTER/CABLE STRAIN RELIEF INTERFACE, ENVIRONMENT RESISTING

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

The requirements for acquiring fiber optic connectors described herein shall consist of this specification sheet and MIL-PRF-64266.

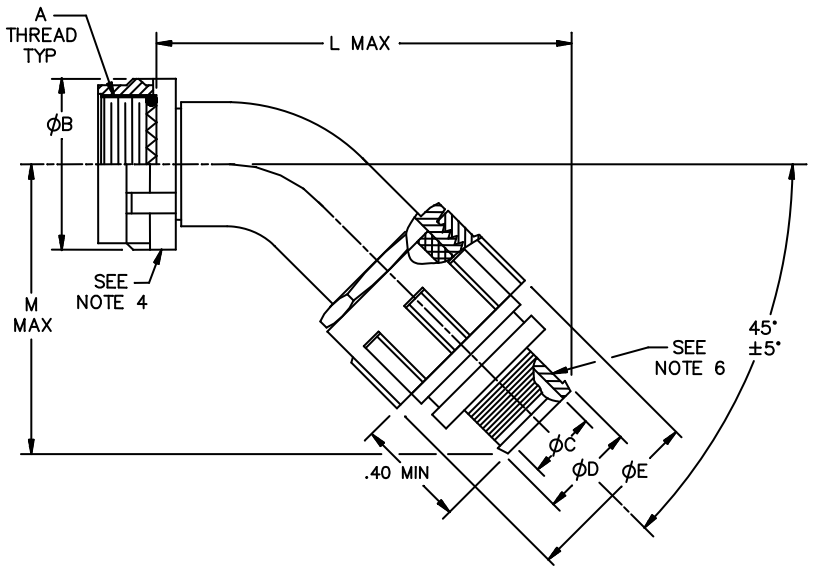
SCOPE. The performance requirements specified herein cover a backshell intended for use with a MIL-PRF-64266 or MIL-DTL-38999 connector plug or receptacle in a fiber optic only application. This backshell is intended for the cable harness configuration in which a bundle of single fiber cables (simplex optical cables) are routed through material, such as cable wrap, to the connector plug or receptacle. This backshell is used for interface with the connector plug or receptacle on one end and contains an interface (platform) to secure the cable wrap with a banding strap on the other end. As an alternative, this platform may be used to secure a cable strain relief (such as heat shrink) to the cable entrance end of the backshell. Environmental resistant features include ability to restrict movement, position, and twist of each cable in addition to eliminate or reduce penetration of various environments.



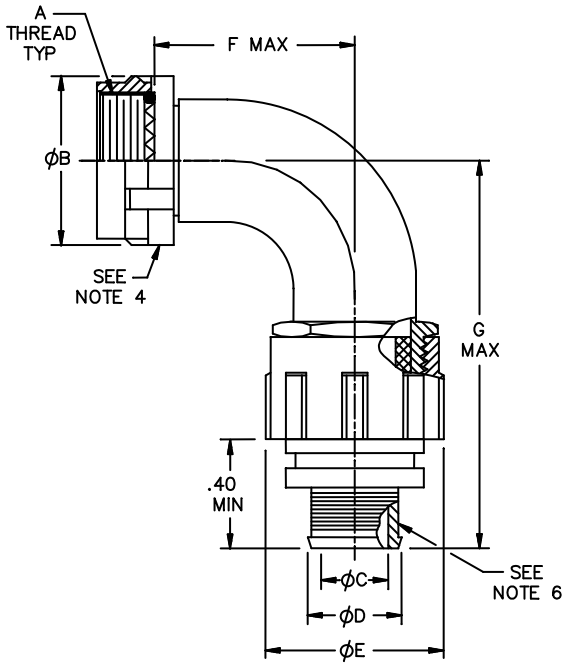
Straight Backshell

FIGURE 1. Straight, 45 and 90 degree backshell orientations.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T03:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



45° backshell



90° backshell

FIGURE 1. Straight, 45 and 90 degree backshell orientations - Continued.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T03:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Shell size	A thread ISO metric	B dia Max		C dia min		D dia max		E dia max	
		inches	mm	inches	mm	inches	mm	inches	mm
11	M15x1.0-6H	1.00	25.4	.31	7.9	.51	13.0	1.38	35.1
13	M18x1.0-6H	1.13	28.7	.38	9.7	.58	14.7	1.38	35.1
15	M22x1.0-6H	1.25	31.8	.50	12.7	.65	16.5	1.38	35.1
17	M25x1.0-6H	1.38	35.1	.50	12.7	.81	20.6	1.56	39.6
19	M28x1.0-6H	1.50	38.1	.63	16.0	.91	23.1	1.56	39.6
21	M31x1.0-6H	1.63	41.4	.69	17.5	1.05	26.7	1.81	46.0
23	M34x1.0-6H	1.75	44.5	.75	19.1	1.18	30.0	1.81	46.0
25	M37x1.0-6H	1.88	47.8	.94	23.9	1.18	30.0	2.12	53.8

Shell size	F Max		G Max		L Max		M Max	
	inches	mm	inches	mm	inches	mm	inches	mm
11	2.0	50.8	3.7	94.0	4.0	101.6	2.5	63.5
13	2.1	53.3	3.7	94.0	4.2	106.7	2.6	66.0
15	2.1	53.3	3.8	96.5	4.2	106.7	2.6	66.0
17	2.2	55.9	3.9	99.1	4.2	106.7	2.6	66.0
19	2.2	55.9	3.9	99.1	4.3	109.2	2.7	68.6
21	2.3	58.4	4.0	101.6	4.3	109.2	2.7	68.6
23	2.4	61.0	4.0	101.6	4.4	111.8	2.8	71.1
25	2.4	61.0	4.0	101.6	4.5	114.3	2.8	71.1

NOTES:
1. Dimensions are in inches.
2. Metric equivalents are given for general information only.
3. Dimensions apply to plated/finished part.
4. Backshell internal configuration not shown. The backshell interface dimensions shall be in accordance with figure A-6 of MIL-PRF-64266.
5. See table IV herein for relationship of cable entry code to shell size.
6. This interface shall be compatible for use of both a banding strap and heat shrink. Banding strap is one with a .25 inch (6.35 mm) nominal band width and a .375 inch (9.53 mm) maximum buckle (locking mechanism) width. Backshell shall withstand an applied 160 lb (72.58 kilograms) linear force around the circumference of the backshell at the band interface surface. The force shall be applied by placing a banding strap onto the backshell using a banding tool.

FIGURE 1. Straight, 45 and 90 degree backshell orientations - Continued.

REQUIREMENTS:

Temperature ranges:
Operating: -67°F to 329°F (-55°C to 165°C)
Non-operating: -40°F to 185°F (-40°C to 85°C)
Storage: -40°F to 185°F (-40°C to 85°C)

Dimensions and configurations: See figure 1 herein and MIL-PRF-64266, figure A-6.

Weight: Weight shall not exceed the specified value in table I for the applicable shell size, cable entry angle and material.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T03:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE I. Backshell weights.

Shell size	Cable entry angle	Composite		Aluminum		Stainless steel	
		Lb	grams	lb	grams	lb	grams
11	straight	.07	31.8	.12	54.4	.34	154.2
	45°,90°	.08	36.3	.15	68.0	.45	204.1
13	straight	.08	36.3	.14	63.5	.40	131.4
	45°,90°	.09	40.3	.16	72.6	.46	208.7
15	straight	.09	40.3	.16	72.6	.46	208.7
	45°,90°	.10	45.4	.18	81.6	.51	231.3
17	straight	.11	49.9	.19	86.2	.55	249.5
	45°,90°	.12	54.4	.23	104.3	.63	285.8
19	straight	.12	54.4	.20	90.7	.60	272.2
	45°,90°	.13	59.0	.23	104.3	.67	303.9
21	straight	.15	68.0	.26	117.9	.75	340.2
	45°,90°	.17	77.1	.31	140.6	.89	403.7
23	straight	.15	68.0	.28	127.0	.78	353.8
	45°,90°	.18	81.6	.32	145.1	.84	381.0
25	straight	.17	77.1	.31	140.6	.89	403.7
	45°,90°	.20	90.7	.35	158.8	1.02	462.7

Fabrication procedure: Standard fabrication procedure (for both the terminus placement/termination onto the end of fiber optic cabling and the assembly of the connector and backshell onto the fiber optic cabling) shall be used. Standard fabrication procedure shall be in accordance with NAVAIR 01-1A-505-4/T.O. 1-1A-14-4/TM 1-1500-323-24-4. A copy of this document can be obtained at web site: https://jswag.navair.navy.mil.

Backshell capture mechanism at the cable entry end (for banding strap or strain cable strain relief): A capture adapter/platform, external on and at the cable entry end of the backshell, shall be used to secure either a stainless steel banding strap or a cable strain relief (such as shrink tubing or heat shrink boot) to the backshell.

Cable restraint mechanism: Backshell shall contain means to provide environmentally resisting support for the single fiber cables exiting the termini. Support shall restrict movement during vibration and shock (act as a vibration dampener), restrict position of each cable (act as a positioner to keep each cable separated), and restrict cable twist (act as a anti-rotation mechanism). The term "gland" shall be used in this specification sheet as the generic term for the cable restraint mechanism, piece or resilient member component of the backshell that is used to provide a degree of environmental sealing, restrict the position of each cable, restricts movement during vibration and shock, and restricts cable twist. The gland may also be referred to as a grommet, resilient bushing or spacer. The gland shall include an anti-rotation feature with a corresponding feature in the backshell. The anti-rotation feature shall position the termini cavities in the gland so that these cavities align with those in the connector insert. Also, the anti-rotation feature shall prevent radial movement of the gland (i.e., prevent twisting of the cabling) once placed in the backshell.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T03:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Requirement for locking mechanism on the backshell coupling nut: The backshell coupling nut shall include a ratchet type locking mechanism (anti-coupling device) to ensure that a backshell mated to a connector maintains full thread engagement (maintains complete coupling). Complete coupling of the mated connector and backshell is achieved by a clockwise rotation of the coupling nut. The anti-coupling mechanism or feature shall be between the backshell coupling nut and the backshell shell only. The locking mechanism shall be sufficient to ensure no backing off of the coupling nut during mechanical shock or vibration.

Wrench flats on composite backshells: Backshell body coupling nuts constructed from composite material shall contain wrench flats or a non-movable hex nut. This wrench flat or hex nut shall be sufficient to permit applying a torque for affixing the backshell to the connector.

Positive stop on gland nut: Backshell body shall contain a positive stop for the gland nut. Once contact (resistance to further tightening) is made, the gland nut shall continue to be tightened until a torque value of 50 ± 10 in-lb is obtained.

Two pieces of SAE AMS-DTL-23053/5 heat shrink, a minimum of 2 inches (50.5 mm) in length (before shrinkage), shall be provided with each backshell as part of the PIN (see Markings below). One piece of heat shrink shall permit shrinkage directly over the gland nut banding platform and cabling exiting the backshell. The other piece of heat shrink shall permit shrinkage over a banding strap affixing cable wrap or braid to the gland nut banding platform.

Cable diameter range (for each of the single fiber cables in the specified shell size): Cable restraint mechanism and environmental sealing design shall accommodate a single fiber cable with a minimum diameter of .067 inch (1.7 mm) and a maximum diameter of .087 inch (2.2 mm).

Identification marking: Applicable. Both initial and after environmental testing.

Backshell-to-connector mating torque: The backshell threads shall withstand the applied torque to mate (affix) the backshell to the connector that is specified in table II with no damage. The backshell shall be mated to a connector mounted in a suitable fixture to prevent movement of the connector during the test. The torque shall be applied to the backshell at a rate of approximately 10 in-lb per second until the specified applied torque is obtained. This torque shall be applied for a minimum of 1 minute.

TABLE II. Backshell-to-connector mating torque.

Shell Size	Mating torque ± 5 in-lb	
	Composite	Metal
11	50	100
13	50	150
15	50	150
17	50	150
19	50	150
21	100	175
23	100	175
25	100	175

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T03:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Cable pull-out force: Not applicable.

Cable seal flexing: Not applicable.

Twist: Applicable. A 5 lb weight shall be applied to the entire cable bundle. Perform on a shell size 15 backshell.

External bending moment: Applicable. Applied bending moment shall be as specified in table III.

TABLE III. Backshell applied bending moment.

Shell size	Minimum applied bending moment					
	Composite		Aluminum		Stainless steel	
	in-lb	N-m	in-lb	N-m	in-lb	N-m
11	25	2.83	125	14.12	125	14.12
13	25	2.83	275	31.07	275	31.07
15	50	5.65	300	33.90	300	33.90
17	50	5.65	300	33.90	300	33.90
19	50	5.65	300	33.90	300	33.90
21	75	8.47	300	33.90	300	33.90
23	75	8.47	300	33.90	300	33.90
25	100	11.30	300	33.90	300	33.90

Impact: Applicable.

Crush: Applicable.

Water pressure: Not applicable.

Banding strap attachment integrity: No buckling, cracking or other backshell damage (including to plating) shall result from attachment of a banding strap when applied to the conditions of note 6 in figure 1.

Freezing water: Not applicable.

Sand and dust: Applicable.

Electromagnetic effects: Applicable. When not tested as part of the initial qualification, the backshell shall be assembled to a MIL-PRF-64266/1 or MIL-PRF-64266/3 receptacle configured with a non-metallic insert. Electromagnetic effects testing shall be conducted both with and without mating the MIL-PRF-64266/1 or MIL-PRF-64266/3 receptacle to a mating plug connector or dust cover.

Salt spray: Applicable.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T03:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Shell-to-shell conductivity: Applicable. Both initial and after salt spray. Perform both initial and after salt spray. For a backshell mated to a connector plug, the voltage drop of the mated connector plug-to-backshell shall be measured from a point on the rear accessory thread of the connector plug to a point on the backshell 1.0 ± .25 inch from the innermost backshell threads that mate with the backshell gland nut. For a backshell mated to a connector receptacle, the voltage drop of the mated connector receptacle-to-backshell shall be measured from a point on the flange of the connector receptacle adjacent to the mounting hole to a point on the backshell 1.0 ± .25 inch from the innermost backshell threads that mate with the backshell gland nut. When tested as part of the initial qualification, the voltage drop between the connector receptacle and connector plug shall be measured also.

Modified SO_2/salt spray: Applicable.

Altitude immersion: Applicable.

Fluid immersion: Applicable.

Cleaning procedures: Each shipment of backshells shall include recommended cleaning procedures. The following wording or equivalent is recommended "To clean, use lint free wipe dampened with alcohol and blow dry with air."

Qualification by similarity:

Backshell configurations to test: The below qualification by similarity is valid if MIL-PRF-64266/14 backshells were placed on the connector receptacles and one MIL-PRF-64266/12 backshell and one MIL-PRF-64266/13 backshell was placed on the connector plugs for each two connector mated pair going through group 1, group 2 or group 3, and group 4 tests.

Temperature range: For inspections and tests performed for this qualification by similarity, tests for temperature range 2 shall be performed for those tests done differently dependent upon the temperature range.

Other shell sizes by test: This qualification by similarity is applicable when testing larger shell sizes in this specification sheet from the initial shell size qualified in this specification sheet. If a connector backshell of one shell size is qualified, and connector backshells with similar design, construction, and materials meet the inspections specified in 4.7.5.1.3 except with the deletion of cable pullout, external bending moment, cable seal flexing, impact, crush, water pressure and temperature cycling, and with the reductions of swept sine only for vibration and MIL-S-901 only for shock, then the backshell of the alternate shell size inspected is qualified.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T03:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Other shell sizes by extension: This qualification by similarity is applicable when testing smaller shell sizes in this specification sheet from the initial shell size qualified in this specification sheet. If a connector backshell of one shell size is qualified, and connector backshells with similar design, construction, and materials meet the inspections specified in 4.7.5.1.4 except with the addition of bending moment, and vibration (swept sine only) and as performed in the qualification test sequence, then the backshells of the alternate shell size inspected are qualified.

Cable entry angle: If a connector backshell with a straight cable entry angle and specified shell size in this specification sheet is qualified, and connector backshells with 45 degree and 90 degree entry angles in this specification sheet meet the visual and mechanical size, weight, identification marking, workmanship, screw thread, and the backshell and backshell accessory attachment inspections, then the connector backshells with 45 degree and 90 degree entry angles for the same shell size are qualified.

Shell sizes in addition to shell sizes 11, 13, 15, and 23: If a connector backshell of shell sizes 11, 13, 15 and 23 in this specification sheet are qualified, and connector backshells of intermediate shell sizes (for use with MIL-DTL-38999 connectors) in this specification sheet meet the visual and mechanical size, weight, identification marking, workmanship, screw thread and the backshell and backshell accessory attachment inspections, then the connector backshells of intermediate shell sizes are qualified.

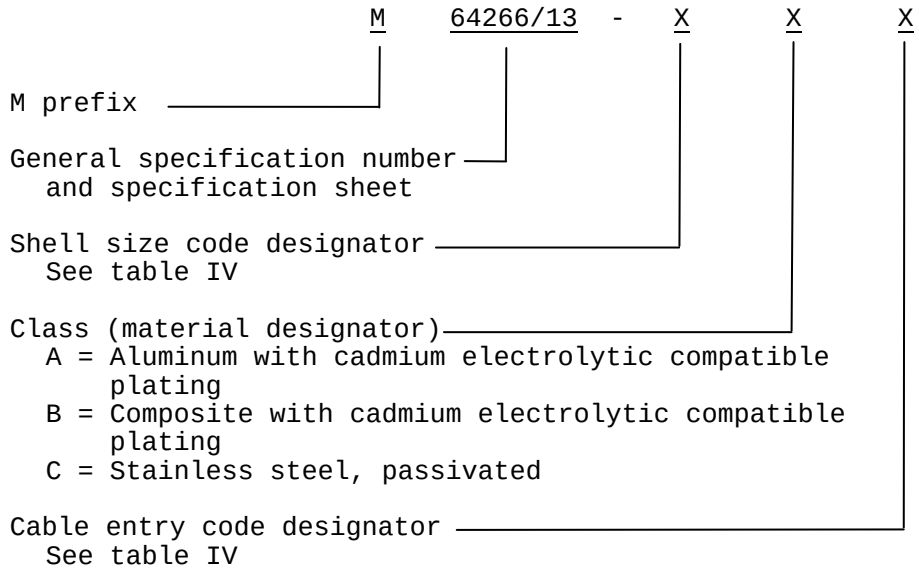
Alternate backshell material: If a connector backshell in this specification sheet made from aluminum is qualified, and connector backshells made from composite or stainless steel in this specification sheet meet the inspections specified in 4.7.5.3 except with the deletion of insert retention radial strength, insert retention axial strength, connector coupling engagement and disengagement torque, cable pullout, mating durability and water pressure and with the addition of shell-to-shell conductivity and modified SO_2/Salt spray, vibration (as performed in the qualification test sequence), then the backshells of the alternate material inspected are qualified.

Alternate plating or plating process: If a connector backshell with one plating or plating process in this specification sheet is qualified, and connector backshells made with a alternate (different type) plating or same type plating using an alternate plating process in this specification sheet meet the inspections specified in 4.7.5.4 except with the deletion of mating durability and with the addition of shell-to-shell conductivity and modified SO_2/Salt spray (as performed in the qualification test sequence), then the backshells with the alternate plating or plating process inspected, as applicable, are qualified.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T03:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Marking:

Part or Identification Number (PIN): Marked on coupling ring of the backshell.



PIN example: M64266/13CAA

TABLE IV. PIN code designators.

Shell size	Shell size code	Cable entry code 1/	Cable entry angle	Connector type	# of insert cavity
11	B	A	Straight	M64266	2
	B	B	45°	M64266	2
	B	C	90°	M64266	2
11	B	L	Straight	M64266	4
	B	M	45°	M64266	4
	B	N	90°	M64266	4
11	B	D	Straight	M38999	2
	B	E	45°	M38999	2
	B	F	90°	M38999	2
13	C	A	Straight	M64266	6
	C	B	45°	M64266	6
	C	C	90°	M64266	6
13	C	D	Straight	M38999	4
	C	E	45°	M38999	4
	C	F	90°	M38999	4
15	D	A	Straight	M64266	10
	D	B	45°	M64266	10
	D	C	90°	M64266	10
15	D	L	Straight	M64266	8
	D	M	45°	M64266	8
	D	N	90°	M64266	8

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T03:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE IV. PIN code designators - Continued.

Shell size	Shell size code	Cable entry code 1/	Cable entry angle	Connector type	# of insert cavity
15	D	D	Straight	M38999	5
	D	E	45°	M38999	5
	D	F	90°	M38999	5
17	E	D	Straight	M38999	8
	E	E	45°	M38999	8
	E	F	90°	M38999	8
19	F	D	Straight	M38999	11
	F	E	45°	M38999	11
	F	F	90°	M38999	11
21	G	D	Straight	M38999	16
	G	E	45°	M38999	16
	G	F	90°	M38999	16
23	H	A	Straight	M64266	36
	H	B	45°	M64266	36
	H	C	90°	M64266	36
23	H	D	Straight	M38999	21
	H	E	45°	M38999	21
	H	F	90°	M38999	21
25	J	D	Straight	M38999	37
	J	E	45°	M38999	37
	J	F	90°	M38999	37
25	J	G	Straight	M38999	29
	J	J	45°	M38999	29
	J	K	90°	M38999	29

1/ Cable entry code based on cable entry angle, connector type and number of cavities in the connector insert.

Mating counterpart: Backshell mates with MIL-PRF-64266/1 wall mounting receptacle, MIL-PRF-64266/2 plug, and MIL-PRF-64266/3 jamnut mounting receptacle.

Installation and removal tools: Adjustable or 1.25 inches (31.8 mm) open end wrench, strap wrench, and scissors.

Referenced documents: In addition to MIL-PRF-64266, this specification sheet references the following documents:

MIL-S-901
MIL-DTL-38999
MIL-PRF-64266/1
MIL-PRF-64266/2
MIL-PRF-64266/3
MIL-PRF-64266/12
MIL-PRF-64266/14
NAVAIR 01-1A-505-4/T.O. 1-1A-14-4/TM 1-1500-323-24-4
SAE AMS-DTL-23053/5

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T03:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Custodians:
Army - CR
Navy - AS
Air Force - 85
DLA - CC

Preparing activity:
DLA - CC

(Project 6060-2009-003)

Review activities:
Army - TE
Navy - SH
Air Force - 13, 19, 93, 99
MISC - DI
MISC - MDA

Civil agencies:
GSA – FAS
NASA - NA

NOTE: The activities listed above were interested in this document on the date of this document. Since organizations and responsibilities can change, you should verify the currency of the information above using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.daps.dla.mil.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T03:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.